

2026 PSML Divisional A Championship

Officials Information

Preparation

- Thank you for volunteering!
- Standard uniforms apply: navy shorts, pants or skirt and a white polo top.
- Bring a refillable water bottle and stay hydrated.
- Wear a hat.
- Use sunscreen.
- Wear shoes that can get wet. They will get wet. Consider bringing a change of socks and shoes.
- Have a rain jacket handy in case the weather turns poor.
- Maybe have some snacks in your pocket. Generally someone will come around and offer water and likely snacks.
- Please check in with the data table when you arrive. This will be on deck by the slide. Write your name, phone number, and team.
- Timers briefing will be given by the starters, at 8:10 by the far side of the pool house (changes will be announced).
- We will have our officials briefing at 8:00am. The location will be at the far side of the pool house by the gear pickup (changes will be announced).
- The meet starts at 8:30am, please be in position by 8:25am.
- Please give the rule book and handbook a re-read before arriving at the meet:
 - [2026 Rules Mini](#)
 - [2026 Rules Full](#)
 - [2026 PMSL Handbook](#)

Pool Details

[Pool Layout](#)

- The pool is 25m, with backstroke flags at 5m on both ends.
- It is 5 ft deep throughout the course, at both the start and turn ends.
- Outside of lane 1 and 6 (to the wall) is a 1 ft buffer containing the ladders, which have a lane rope protecting it.
- The start end is closest to the fence. The turn end is closest to the pool house. There are 6 lanes.
- The lane lines are marked in red for 15m (each direction). We'll have a marking on the pool deck (by the diving boards) for 15m. We will observe this with a Chief Judge (CJ).
- We will not walk for stroke in any event.
- There is 1/2 inch lip at the edge of the pool.
- There is no gutter. The top edge of the pool is about 6 inches or more from the water line.

- For 25m events (8U events, 10U butterfly), the timers will move to the turn end, which will be the finish end for the swimmers. A CJ will be located at the turn end.

Stroke Briefing

Backstroke

- Watch for grabbing on the lane rope and pulling, not just pushing away.
- Resubmerge after the flags immediately before finish ok now.
- Watch toes throughout the race. After 2nd long whistle, if toes proper, put your hands behind your back. If not, hold an arm out and ask the swimmer to fix their toes. This means one two from each foot on the wall.

Butterfly

- Resubmerge after the flags immediately before finish ok now.

Breaststroke

(No notes provided.)

Freestyle

- Resubmerge after the flags immediately before finish ok now.

Individual Medley

- Back finish on back, watch for flip turns.

Freestyle Relay

(No notes provided.)

Medley Relay

(No notes provided.)

- The benefit of the doubt goes to the swimmer.
- If you see a violation, raise your hand for 3-5 seconds, and jot down what you observed on the program. This is not a DQ necessarily, but an invitation for a discussion. You write it down as you may have a number of violations in a short time period and you have to explain to the referee or CJ when they chat with you.
- Be ready to describe your observation in terms of the rule book style of violation. If it is a single hand touch, note which hand, and where the other hand was located. Note where the violation occurs (which pool length, which stroke for IM, approaching the turn or leaving the wall, etc.).

Chief Judge

- The CJ will take order of finish (OOF) for the 25m events (turn end), standing outside of lane 1 (closest to the diving board).
- The CJ will adjudicate violations at the turn and start ends, and will place their initials next to the judge's name. The referee approves or rejects all DQs.

- The CJ will stand at the 15m mark for events which require surfacing by the mark (butterfly, back, free) for events 50m or longer.
- Turn in the program to the data table at the end of the meet, labelled at the top with "CJ (number)" and your name.
- If there is a lane with no swimmer and there should be one, cross off that name/lane on your program.
- If there is a lane which should not have a swimmer and one swims, note that there is a swimmer in that lane, maybe writing "swimmer" (as you won't be able to get the name). This could happen if someone swims in the wrong heat or lane, or if heats have been collapsed, or swimmers moved around. We may have alternates placed into heats.

Starter

- To indicate a false start, the starter will mark the swimmer's lane number(s) and initiate a call with the referee, something "I have a possible false start", and show the clipboard to the referee. If the referee also confirms the same swimmer, it is a false start (and a discussion over what may have caused it). If determined to actually be a false start, the starter will write up the DQ slip (the ref will provide one) and will sign it as the judge.
- The starter will take order of finish (OOF) for the 50m and 100m events (start end). The CJ will get the OOF for 25m events.
- Turn in the program to the data table at the end of the meet, labelled at the top with "SR (number)" and your name.
- If there is a lane with no swimmer and there should be one, cross off that name/lane on your program.
- If there is a lane which should not have a swimmer and one swims, note that there is a swimmer in that lane, maybe writing "swimmer" (as you won't be able to get the name). This could happen if someone swims in the wrong heat or lane, or if heats have been collapsed, or swimmers moved around. We may have alternates seeded into heats.
- Clerk of Course will generally notify the referee and maybe the starter when changes happen, as a best effort attempt.

Jurisdiction

- Six STs will be used, two at each end and two will be off. We have a rotation schedule that allows for 4 strokes on and two strokes break. We will use off-ST for medley relay take off judges.
- Each ST will watch 3 lanes and half the pool.
- ST will be positioned as follows:
 - Lanes 1, 2, 3 on the line between 2 and 3 (two lanes to one side, one to the other).
 - Lanes 4, 5, 6 on the line between 4 and 5 (two lanes to one side, one to the other).
- Be sure to mirror your partner on the other side of the pool. If you're both not in the same spot (lane line), double check your position and fix it accordingly.
- Step up to the wall when the swimmer is in your jurisdiction, and step back when they leave (half pool).
- You will need to step fully to the edge and lean over the edge to see the touch.
- At the start end, stay back for the start (3 ft or more), and step forward after the start. If you see timers too close to the start, remind them too to step back.

- Freestyle events will have ST at corners (lane 1 and lane 6 sides), watching that the swimmer touches the wall (as well as other potential violations).
- STs will rotate after each event as follows, according to the schedule:
 - After MR and butterfly (events 1-10)
 - After freestyle (events 11-20)
 - After breast (events 21-30)
 - 10 minute break
 - After backstroke (events 31-40)
 - After IM (events 41-46)
 - 10 minute break
 - Relays (events 47-49) [complete]
- We will rotate clockwise. Start lane 4-6 rotates to Off, and Turn lane 1-3 rotates to Off.
- After the break we will do the 8U relay and the 200 FR.
- For relay take off judging, we will watch all 6 lanes (from the outside of lane 1 and 6):
 - 200m MR (events 1, 2) — 4 ST in stroke and turn positions, and 2 off-ST at the start end take-off judges.
 - 100m 8U FR (event 47) — all 4 ST judges will be on corners and act as take-off judges for relay exchanges.
 - 200m FR (events 48, 49) — all 4 ST judges will be on corners. Turn end will watch for the touch, and start end will handle take-off relay exchanges.
- Take off judges (TOJ) will watch all 6 lanes, looking for the feet of the outgoing swimmer to leave the wall, and then at the incoming swimmer to be sure they have touched. If the touch happens before the feet leave, circle that swimmer number on the TOJ sheet. If touch has not happened, mark an X in that swimmer number. Do not raise your arm for this call. We require dual confirmation. The referee will confer with the closest TOJ. If there is no violation, they will not check the other TOJ.
- The ST will watch for suit violations. Please raise your hand if you see this and note it on your program:
 - Improper suits
 - We will try to have identified any suit waivers in advance.

Links

- [Officials List](#)
- [Officials Schedule](#)
- [Coaches and Representative Information](#)
- [Notable Rules and Changes](#)